Conversation track 1, 3, 4

Jonah can't find his wallet. His friend Joanna helps him retrace his steps.

Joanna: OK, don't panic. When did you last see it?

Jonah: At lunch. I paid, so I **must have had** it then.

Joanna: Then you **might have left** it on the table.

Jonah: No, I **can't have left** it there. I put it right back in my jacket.

Joanna: What about the bus? It **could've slipped** out when you sat down.

Jonah: Maybe. Or someone **might have taken** it. It was so crowded.

Joanna: Wait a second. What's that in your back pocket?

Jonah: Oh, wow. I **must have put** it there without thinking. Don't tell anyone!

Study Notes

When did you last see it?
Lần cuối bạn thấy nó là khi nào?
Câu hỏi quen thuộc khi tìm đồ thất lạc; chú ý "last" đứng trước động từ chính.
Cách nói tương đương: When was the last time you had it?

I must have put it there without thinking.
Chắc mình tiện tay bỏ vào đó mà không để ý.
"without thinking" = làm theo phản xạ, theo thói quen, không suy nghĩ.
Cách nói tương đương: I must have done it on autopilot.

Speak Like a Native track 2

1. I paid, so I must have had it then.
change: "must have" (→ /ˈmʌstəv/)
strong: "paid", "must"

"must have" đọc nhanh thành "mớs-tơv": "have" chỉ còn /əv/, âm /t/ nối sang. Nhấn "paid" (bằng chứng) và "must" (chắc chắn); "then" đã rõ nên đọc nhẹ.

2. No, I can't have left it there.
change: "can't have" (→ /ˈkæntəv/)
linking: "left‿it"
strong: "can't", "there"

Giọng Mỹ đọc "can't" với âm /æ/ mở rộng: "ken-tơv"; còn "can" chỉ là /kən/. "left it" nối thành "lép-tit". Nhấn "can't": phủ định chắc chắn.

3. It could've slipped out when you sat down.
weak: "could've"
linking: "slipped‿out"
change: "sat down" (mất âm t)
strong: "slipped", "sat"

"could've" = could have, đọc "cu-đơv". Đuôi -ed của "slipped" đọc /t/ và nối sang "out": "slip-tao". "sat down" mất âm /t/: "se-đaon".

• must have / might have / could've: "have" đọc nhẹ /əv/ → "mớs-tơv", "mai-đơv", "cu-đơv".
• Đuôi -ed sau /p/, /k/, /s/… đọc là /t/ và nối sang nguyên âm phía sau: slipped out → "slip-tao".
• Âm /t/ đứng trước phụ âm thường mất: sat down → "se-đaon".
• Khi suy đoán, nhấn vào modal để thể hiện độ chắc chắn: I MUST have…, I CAN'T have…

Grammar Focus

must have / can't have + V3: chắc chắn về quá khứ

must have + V3 = chắc chắn đã…; can't have (hoặc couldn't have) + V3 = chắc chắn đã không… Dùng khi có bằng chứng rõ ràng.

The lights are off. They **must have gone** to bed.
She **can't have seen** us. She didn't wave.
You **must have been** tired after the trip.

might / could have + V3: có lẽ đã (không chắc)

might / could have + V3 = có lẽ đã…, có thể đúng hoặc sai. Phủ định: might not have + V3 (có lẽ đã không…).

He's late. He **might have missed** the bus.
I **could have left** my umbrella at work.
Where's Tom? – He **might have gone** home.

Role Play track 6

A: OK, don't panic. When did you last see it?

B: At lunch. I paid, so I must have had it then.

A: Then you might have left it on the table.

B: No, I can't have _____. I put it right back in my jacket.

A: What about the bus? It could've slipped out when you sat down.

B: Maybe. Or someone might have _____. It was so crowded.

A: Wait a second. What's that in your back pocket?

B: Oh, wow. I must have _____ without thinking. Don't tell anyone!

Substitution Drill track 7

1. No, I can't have **left it there**.
   a. dropped it
   b. forgotten it
   c. lost it that fast

2. Or someone might have **taken it**.
   a. picked it up
   b. stolen it
   c. kicked it under a seat

3. I must have **put it there** without thinking.
   a. moved it
   b. switched pockets
   c. stuck it in there